

Use-Case Flow Specification

UC-002 — Submit Competitive Bid

Primary Actor: Freight Carrier

Supporting Actor: Shipper

Goal: Allow a verified carrier to submit a competitive bid for an available freight shipment during the active auction timeframe.

Preconditions

- The Freight Carrier has an account on the marketplace.
- The Freight Carrier is verified and has valid permits.
- A Shipper has posted an available freight shipment.
- The shipment auction period is active.
- The carrier has access to the marketplace.

Postconditions

- The bid is stored and associated with the shipment.
- The Shipper is notified of the new bid.
- The bid remains available for review until the auction closes.
- If submission fails, the bid is not recorded and the carrier is informed of the reason.

Main Success Scenario

1. The Freight Carrier logs into the marketplace.
2. The system authenticates the carrier.
3. The system verifies the carrier's verification status and permits.
4. The carrier browses available freight shipments.
5. The carrier selects a suitable freight shipment.
6. The system displays shipment details, including cargo, pickup location, delivery location, vehicle requirements, and auction deadline.
7. The carrier enters the proposed bid amount and required bid information.
8. The carrier submits the bid.
9. The system verifies that the auction timeframe is still active.
10. The system records the bid against the shipment.
11. The system confirms successful bid submission to the carrier.
12. The system notifies the Shipper about the newly submitted bid.
13. The Shipper can review the bid with other submitted bids.

Alternate Flow — AF-01: Auction Has Closed

1. At Step 9, the system determines that the auction deadline has passed.
2. The system rejects the bid submission.
3. The system informs the carrier that the auction is closed.
4. The bid is not recorded.

5. The carrier may return to the available shipment list and select another active shipment.